continued safeguards" as the "first necessary step away from the crisis." He explained to Khrushchev that he had mentioned IL-28 bombers as part of the offensive weapons arsenal in his address to the nation on October 22, and thus they were covered by his exchange with Khrushchev, in which the president had referred to offensive weapons of all kinds. He assured Khrushchev that he would not extend the meaning of the term any further, and that it was only the bombers that bothered him. "There is really only one major item on the list, beyond the missiles and their equipment, and that is the light bombers with their equipment," wrote Kennedy to Khrushchev. "This item is indeed of great importance to us."[2]

Khrushchev must have felt trapped. With his ballistic missiles dismantled, the American promise to lift the blockade yet to be fulfilled, and their promise not to invade Cuba not formalized through the UN Security Council, he had nothing to show for his Cuban adventure but spoiled relations with both the United States and Cuba. The other American promise, to remove missiles from Turkey, besides remaining secret, now seemed more remote than ever.

Faced with Kennedy's insistence that the entire deal on Cuba hung on the removal of the IL-28 bombers, and confronted with the revolt of Castro and the Cubans, Khrushchev paused to consider the matter. For the time being at least, he wanted not only his bombers but also his tactical nuclear weapons—the nuclear-armed Luna missiles, about which the Americans knew nothing—to stay in place. On Khrushchev's orders Marshal Malinovsky instructed General Pliev in Cuba: "With regard to warheads for 'Luna,' FKR [cruise missiles] and IL-28 airplanes, so far their withdrawal has not been discussed. They should be left in Cuba under your command."[3]

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THE KEY DISCUSSION ON WHAT TO DO ABOUT KENNEDY'S NEW demands took place at the party Presidium meeting on Saturday, November 10. Khrushchev, who had been in retreat ever since Kennedy announced the discovery of the ballistic missiles in Cuba, decided to pull back even further